Adam Hickey

Senior Product Designer · Complex Systems · Design Systems · Agentic Workflows · Prototyping in Code

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Professional summary

Senior product designer with 20 years designing complicated enterprise software and systems for organizations including Cargill, Intel, CBRE and Toro. My work has moved from interface craft, to design systems and governance at scale, to designing and building working products with coding agents. I'm now focused on the product-design problems created when AI can act: how autonomy is bounded, how design systems become executable guidance, what can be verified automatically, and where human judgment still belongs. I bring enterprise systems experience, interaction design and hands-on prototyping in code to teams figuring out how the next generation of software gets made.

Experience

Selected Independent Work — Product design, systems, prototyping 2026 – Present

- **Agent Review** — Designed and built a React and TypeScript prototype for delegating UI work to coding agents. Defined the agent's boundaries, twelve written design rules, and automated visual and accessibility checks; ran the same feature with and without the rules to find where automation ends and human judgment begins.
- **Dispatch Cockpit** — Designed a decision-support prototype for AI-assisted load assignment, making evidence, confidence, overrides and the manual path visible to expert dispatchers.
- **Lucy Learns** and **Door County Found** — two products in use, defined, designed and built end to end: an offline-first training app and a regional travel guide built on structured data.

RBA Inc — Lead UX Product Designer 2013 – 2026

- Led enterprise product design and UX strategy for clients in manufacturing, healthcare, financial services, and the public sector, including compliance-sensitive work for a federal agency, a regional bank and healthcare providers.
- Tied design decisions to the numbers product, engineering and business teams already track: efficiency, adoption, quality, ROI.
- Built and governed design systems across SAP, Microsoft, Umbraco, and Sitecore platforms: tokens, component libraries, contribution rules and release checkpoints. Led accessibility, DesignOps and governance practices.
- Used AI to scale the design system: drafting documentation, auditing for drift, checking design against code, and pulling research together. Human judgment on every decision.

Selected projects

- Scaling enterprise product design across 40+ SAP applications: one design system and accessibility standard, about a third less time from design to development, and UI defects in production cut roughly in half.
- Cutting data-analysis requests from 45–55 hours to just over 10 with a USDA grant-management portal (research, workflows, accessibility).
- Orchestrating real-time logistics for a 450+ truck fleet: cockpit UI, fleet visibility and the decision surface itself, for a dispatcher who is short on attention rather than short on data.

Core capabilities

Product Strategy · UX & Interaction Design · Information Architecture · Research & Usability · Complex Workflows · Design Systems & Governance · Accessibility · Decision-Support Interfaces · Human–AI Interaction · Agentic Workflows · AI Autonomy & Escalation · Design-to-Code Systems

Tools & platforms

Prototyping & build: React · TypeScript · HTML/CSS/JavaScript · Storybook · Playwright · Vitest & axe · Git/GitHub · Claude Code (skills, plugins, MCP)
Design & platforms: Figma/FigJam (variables, Dev Mode, component libraries) · CSS custom properties (tokens) · ChatGPT & Gemini · SAP Fiori · Sitecore · Umbraco · WCAG 2.1 AA

Education

Bachelor of Science in Graphic Design, University of Minnesota–Twin Cities (2005)

Prior professional experience

Pixel Farm — Interactive Designer / Developer Jan 2008 – Apr 2013
Shipped two native iOS apps and an iPad app, plus configurator and store-locator builds for Lund Boats and Fulton Beer. Built front-end experiences in HTML, CSS and jQuery across Joomla! and WordPress; led rebrands and visual identity systems.

LEVEL — Interactive Designer Jan 2006 – Jan 2008
Designed and built front-end websites in HTML, CSS, and Flash with project managers, creative leads, writers, and developers.

ByDesign — Design Intern 2004 – 2006